

Absolutely — **coffee** is a useful secondary polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “At first, I just went in for a quick **coffee** and a bun...”

Here **coffee** means **a prepared drink made from roasted coffee beans**, probably one serving/cup. But the word also commonly refers to **the beans/grounds themselves, coffee as a substance, a serving/cup, a social coffee break, and coffee-coloured shades**.

Word family: **coffee**

Base word: coffee

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / attributive noun (名詞作前置修飾語)

Meaning in your passage: **coffee** = a serving/drink of coffee — 咖啡；一杯咖啡

Your sentence:

> “I just went in for a quick **coffee** and a bun.”

Here **coffee** means:

> **a prepared coffee drink, understood as one serving.**

繁體中文：

一杯沖調好的咖啡飲品

Natural translation:

> “a quick coffee and a bun”

「快速喝杯**咖啡**，再吃個麵包」

So here:

> **coffee** = 一杯咖啡飲品

1. **coffee** = drink made from roasted coffee beans — 咖啡

The core meaning.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I went in for a quick **coffee**.”

「我進去快速喝杯**咖啡**。」

Practice 2

> “She drinks coffee every morning.”

「她每天早上都喝**咖啡**。」

Practice 3

> “The coffee smells excellent.”

「這杯**咖啡**聞起來很香。」

****coffee = 用烘焙咖啡豆研磨後沖泡而成的飲品****

2. ****a coffee = one serving/cup of coffee — 一杯咖啡****

A very important countable use.

Practice 4

> “Can I have ****a coffee****, please?”

「我可以要****一杯咖啡****嗎？」

Practice 5

> “We ordered two coffees.”

「我們點了****兩杯咖啡****。」

****a coffee / coffees = 一杯 / 幾杯咖啡飲品****

Important countability contrast:

> coffee = 咖啡這種飲品 / 物質

> a coffee = 一杯咖啡

3. ****coffee = coffee beans/ground coffee as a product — 咖啡豆；咖啡粉；咖啡產品****

A common material/product sense.

Practice 6

> “This shop sells freshly roasted **coffee**.”

「這間店出售新鮮烘焙的**咖啡豆 / 咖啡產品**。」

Practice 7

> “Keep the coffee in an airtight container.”

「把**咖啡粉 / 咖啡豆**放在密封容器裡。」

coffee = 用來沖泡咖啡的咖啡豆、咖啡粉或咖啡產品

Context decides the exact Chinese.

4. **coffee = coffee plant/crop — 咖啡作物；咖啡**

A major agricultural sense.

Practice 8

> “The region grows **coffee**.”

「這個地區種植**咖啡**。」

Practice 9

> “Coffee is an important export crop.”

「**咖啡**是一種重要出口作物。」

coffee = 咖啡植物及其作為農產品的作物

This is not about the prepared drink.

5. **coffee = social occasion / coffee break — 喝咖啡的聚會；咖啡時間**

A common conversational/social use.

Practice 10

> “Let’s meet for **coffee**.”

「我們約出來**喝杯咖啡 / 聊聊天**吧。」

Practice 11

> “We had coffee after the meeting.”

「會議後我們一起**喝咖啡聊了一會兒**。」

****coffee = 以喝咖啡為中心的短暫社交會面****

The focus may be the social interaction, not the drink itself.

6. ****coffee break = 咖啡休息時間；小休****

A very common compound.

Practice 12

> “We took a short ****coffee break****.”

「我們小休了一會兒，去****喝咖啡休息****。」

Practice 13

> “The meeting resumes after the coffee break.”

「會議在****小休 / 咖啡休息時間****後繼續。」

****coffee break = 工作 / 會議期間短暫休息的時間，傳統上可用來喝咖啡****

7. ****coffee shop = 咖啡店****

A common compound.

Practice 14

> “There is a small ****coffee shop**** next to the bakery.”

「麵包店旁邊有一間小**咖啡店**。」

Practice 15

> “The coffee shop serves pastries as well.”

「這間**咖啡店**也供應酥點。」

****coffee shop = 主要供應咖啡及簡單食品的店舖****

8. ****coffee table = 咖啡桌；矮桌****

A lexicalized household compound.

Practice 16

> “The magazine is on the ****coffee table****.”

「雜誌放在****咖啡桌 / 客廳矮桌****上。」

Practice 17

> “They bought a wooden coffee table.”

「他們買了一張木製****咖啡桌****。」

****coffee table = 客廳中較矮、通常放在沙發前的桌子****

It is not necessarily used only for coffee.

9. ****coffee-table book = 大型精裝圖文書；適合陳列的畫冊****

A useful lexicalized compound.

Practice 18

> “The museum published a beautiful ****coffee-table book****.”

「博物館出版了一本漂亮的大型****精裝畫冊****。」

Practice 19

> “The book is more visual than academic.”

「這本書比較偏視覺欣賞，而不是學術性。」

coffee-table book = 大型、精美、圖片豐富，常放在客廳供翻閱展示的書

10. **coffee = brown colour / coffee-coloured — 咖啡色；啡色**

A colour extension.

Practice 20

> “She chose a warm **coffee brown** for the wall.”

「她為牆面選了一種溫暖的**咖啡啡色**。」

Practice 21

> “The bag is coffee-coloured.”

「這個袋是**咖啡色 / 啡色**的。」

coffee colour = 像咖啡般的棕啡色

In Hong Kong usage, **啡色** is especially natural.

11. **coffee grounds = 咖啡渣**

A common product-state compound.

Practice 22

> “Do not pour **coffee grounds** into the sink.”

「不要把**咖啡渣**倒進洗手盆。」

Practice 23

> “The café composts used coffee grounds.”

「這間咖啡店會把用過的**咖啡渣**拿去堆肥。」

****coffee grounds = 沖泡咖啡後剩下的咖啡粉渣****

12. ****coffee bean = 咖啡豆****

Practice 24

> “These ****coffee beans**** were roasted this morning.”

「這些****咖啡豆****今早才烘焙。」

Practice 25

> “Different coffee beans produce different flavours.”

「不同****咖啡豆****會產生不同風味。」

****coffee bean = 咖啡植物種子，經處理、烘焙後用來沖泡咖啡****

Important distinction: ****coffee vs a coffee****

****coffee****

uncountable:

> “I drink coffee.”

= 我喝咖啡。

****a coffee****

countable serving:

> “I ordered a coffee.”

= 我點了一杯咖啡。

This is one of the most important grammar contrasts.

Important distinction: ****coffee vs coffee beans****

coffee

can refer broadly to the product/drink.

coffee beans

specifically:

whole roasted/unroasted beans.

> coffee smells good

> could mean the brewed drink.

> coffee beans smell good

> specifically beans.

Important distinction: **coffee vs ground coffee**

coffee beans

whole beans

ground coffee

研磨後的咖啡粉

coffee

context may refer to either the drink or product broadly.

So context is essential.

Important distinction: **coffee vs espresso**

coffee

broad category.

espresso

specific brewing style producing a concentrated small serving.

So:

> espresso is coffee

> but not all coffee is espresso.

Important distinction: **coffee vs café**

coffee

= 飲品

café

= 咖啡店 / 咖啡館

Do not confuse:

> “I had a coffee.”

> = 我喝了一杯咖啡。

> “I went to a café.”

> = 我去了咖啡店。

Important distinction: **coffee shop vs café**

They overlap strongly.

coffee shop

emphasizes coffee-selling establishment.

café

often broader:

coffee + light meals/snacks, sometimes more sit-down.

Usage varies by region.

Important distinction: **meet for coffee vs drink coffee**

drink coffee

focuses on beverage consumption.

meet for coffee

often means:

> casual social meeting

Even if one person orders tea, the expression can still mean a casual meet-up.

Important distinction: **coffee break vs break**

break

general pause from work.

coffee break

a short work pause traditionally associated with coffee.

You do not necessarily have to drink coffee during it.

Important distinction: **coffee table vs table**

table

general furniture.

coffee table

specific low table in a sitting/living area.

Lexicalized compound; not simply any table used for coffee.

Family/compound sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory includes:

* **coffee — drink** = 咖啡
 * **a coffee** = 一杯咖啡
 * **coffee — beans/grounds/product** = 咖啡豆 / 咖啡粉 / 咖啡產品
 * **coffee — crop** = 咖啡作物
 * **coffee — social occasion** = 喝咖啡聚會 / 咖啡時間
 * **coffee break** = 咖啡休息 / 小休
 * **coffee shop** = 咖啡店
 * **coffee table** = 咖啡桌 / 客廳矮桌
 * **coffee-table book** = 大型精裝圖文書 / 畫冊
 * **coffee colour** = 咖啡色 / 啡色
 * **coffee grounds** = 咖啡渣
 * **coffee bean** = 咖啡豆

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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coffee — drink	用烘焙咖啡豆研磨後沖泡而成的飲品
a coffee	一杯 / 一份咖啡飲品
coffee — product	用來沖泡飲品的咖啡豆、咖啡粉或相關咖啡產品
coffee — crop	作為農作物種植及收成的咖啡植物 / 咖啡豆
coffee — social occasion	以喝咖啡為中心的短暫社交會面
coffee break	工作 / 會議期間的短暫小休
coffee shop	主要供應咖啡及簡單食品的店舖
coffee table	客廳中通常放在沙發前的矮桌
coffee-table book	大型、精美、圖片豐富，適合展示翻閱的書
coffee colour	像咖啡般的棕啡色
coffee grounds	沖泡咖啡後剩下的咖啡粉渣

For your original sentence

> “At first, I just went in for a quick **coffee** and a bun...”

The exact meaning is:

**coffee = 一杯沖好的咖啡飲品；a quick coffee 帶有「快速進去喝杯咖啡」的日常口語感。 **

Natural translation:

> **「起初，我只是進去快速喝杯咖啡，再吃個麵包。」 **

The highest-value contrasts are:

> **drink coffee** → 喝咖啡

- > **a coffee** → 一杯咖啡
- > **coffee beans** → 咖啡豆
- > **ground coffee** → 咖啡粉
- > **meet for coffee** → 約出來喝咖啡 / 聊天
- > **coffee break** → 小休
- > **coffee table** → 客廳矮桌
- > **coffee colour** → 咖啡色 / 啡色